

Kokoschka and Schiele

Oskar Kokoschka (1886–1980) was an Austrian artist, poet and playwright who became known for his intense, expressive portraits and landscapes. In 1908, while studying at Vienna's School of Arts and Crafts, he wrote a play, *Murderer, Hope of Women*, and exhibited at the Kunstschau exhibition. The violence of his images made the art particularly controversial, and he was dismissed from the School. He went on to become one of the leading exponents of Expressionism, with richly coloured, gestural, psychologically probing portraits and dramatic cityscapes.

Strongly influenced by Klimt and Kokoschka, Egon Schiele (1890–1918) was a superb draughtsman, and painted sexually intense subjects with a raw approach to brushwork and colour. His twisted body shapes and expressive contours make him, like Kokoschka, an early exponent of Expressionism. His probing self-portraits, gaunt figures and Art Nouveau cityscapes became more complex and contorted, deliberately disquieting, and horrified many. Yet he became successful in certain circles before his untimely death.



Schiele, *Seated Woman with Bent Knee*, 1917